

PEN + INK



(INTRO WORKSHEET)

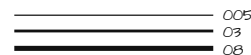
INK IS THE BOLD, BRAVE COUSIN OF THE PENCIL. THERE'S NO ERASER, SO EVERY MARK YOU MAKE STAYS ON THE PAGE. THAT'S WHY INK LOOKS SO CONFIDENT: COMICS, TATTOOS, POSTERS AND STREET ART ALL LIVE HERE. LET'S MEET THE TOOLS.

01 THE INK FAMILY



FINELINER (MICRON)

A STEADY LINE THAT NEVER CHANGES. COMES IN TIP SIZES. BEST FOR DETAILS.



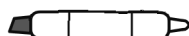
BALLPOINT

THE ONLY PEN WHERE PRESSING HARDER MAKES IT DARKER. GREAT FOR SKETCHING.



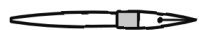
BRUSH PEN

A SOFT, BENDY TIP. PRESS FOR THICK, LIFT FOR THIN, ALL IN ONE STROKE.



MARKER (SHARPIE)

POINT FOR LINES, CHISEL FOR BIG BOLD BLACKS. BLEEDS THROUGH THIN PAPER.

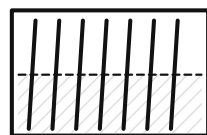


DIP PEN + INDIA INK

OLD SCHOOL: DIP A METAL NIB IN INK. THE LINE SWELLS AS YOU PRESS. WATCH FOR SLOTS!

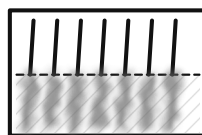


02 PERMANENT VS. WATER-BASED



PERMANENT

SHARPIE, MICRON, INDIA INK. ONCE IT'S DRY, WATER CAN'T MOVE IT.

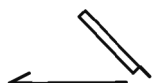


WATER-BASED

WASHABLE MARKERS, FLAIR PENS, MOST BRUSH PENS. WATER MELTS THE LINE INTO A WASH.

INK ISN'T ONLY BLACK. WATER IT DOWN FOR GRAYS (A WASH), GRAB COLORED INKS AND MARKERS, OR LET A WATER-BASED LINE BLEED INTO A SOFT SHADOW ON PURPOSE.

03 HANDLING INK



PULL, DON'T PUSH
PUSHING MAKES THE TIP SKIP AND SNAG



LIGHT TOUCH
PRESSING HARD BENDS A FINELINER TIP FOR GOOD



LET IT DRY
WET INK SMEARS. REST YOUR HAND ON SCRAP PAPER



TURN THE PAPER
SO EVERY LINE IS A COMFORTABLE PULL

GOLDEN RULE: SKETCH LIGHT IN PENCIL, THEN INK WHAT YOU MEAN. ONE CONFIDENT LINE BEATS FIVE SHAKY ONES. MADE A MISTAKE? INK CAN'T BE ERASED, SO MAKE IT PART OF THE DRAWING.

04 INK VOCAB

LINE WEIGHT: HOW THICK OR THIN A LINE IS.

TIP SIZE: BIGGER NUMBER, THICKER LINE.

CHISEL TIP: A FLAT, ANGLED MARKER TIP.

PERMANENT: WATER CAN'T MOVE IT ONCE DRY.

NIB: THE METAL TIP OF A DIP PEN.

BLEED: INK SPREADING PAST THE LINE OR PAPER.

WASH: INK THINNED WITH WATER FOR GRAYS.

GHOSTING: PRACTICING A STROKE IN THE AIR FIRST.

INK WARM-UPS

COMPLETE ALL FIVE BOXES. PEN ONLY: NO PENCIL FIRST, NO ERASING. THIS ISN'T ABOUT MAKING SOMETHING PRETTY. IT'S ABOUT FINDING OUT WHAT EACH TOOL DOES.

1 TIP TEST STRIP

PICK FIVE DIFFERENT PENS OR MARKERS. IN EACH BOX, WRITE THE PEN'S NAME, DRAW ONE STRAIGHT LINE, THEN FILL THE SMALL SQUARE SOLID. WHICH ONES FILL A SOLID BLACK, AND WHICH LEAVE STREAKS?

PEN: _____ 	PEN: _____ 	PEN: _____ 	PEN: _____ 	PEN: _____ 
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2 THIN SIDE, FAT SIDE

ONE MARKER, THREE LINES. WRITE YOUR NAME WITH THE POINT, THEN WITH THE FLAT SIDE OF THE CHISEL. IN THE LAST BOX, TWIST THE CHISEL SLOWLY AS YOU PULL, SO THE LINE TURNS FROM THIN TO FAT (A RIBBON).

A. POINT	B. CHISEL	C. TWIST (RIBBON) 
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3 PRESSURE TEST

WITH A BALLPOINT, SCRIBBLE FROM FEATHER-LIGHT ON THE LEFT TO PRESSING HARD ON THE RIGHT. THEN TRY THE SAME THING WITH A FINELINER IN THE BOTTOM STRIP.

BALLPOINT
FINELINER

WHAT CHANGED, AND WHAT DIDN'T? _____

4 WATER TEST

DRAW FIVE LINES IN EACH BOX. BOX A WITH A PERMANENT PEN, BOX B WITH A WATER-BASED MARKER. THEN BRUSH CLEAN WATER ACROSS THE BOTTOM HALF OF BOTH BOXES.

A. PERMANENT	B. WATER-BASED
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5 SMEAR + BLEED TEST

A: DRAW A THICK LINE AND SWIPE YOUR FINGER ACROSS IT RIGHT AWAY. B: DRAW ANOTHER, COUNT TO 30, THEN SWIPE. C: HOLD A SHARPIE STILL ON THE PAPER FOR 3 SECONDS. THEN FLIP YOUR PAPER OVER.

A. SWIPE IT WET	B. SWIPE IT DRY	C. HOLD IT (3 SEC)
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DID C BLEED THROUGH TO THE BACK? YES / NO. SO WHAT PAPER WOULD YOU USE? _____

QUICK FACT: "INDIA INK" WAS ACTUALLY INVENTED IN CHINA. IT GOT ITS ENGLISH NAME FROM THE TRADE ROUTES THAT CARRIED IT THROUGH INDIA.